Pavel Kocourek

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Research Interests

Game Theory · Dynamic Games · Information Economics · Industrial Organization · Decision-Making Under Uncertainty · Bounded Rationality · Information Processing · AI Safety and Governance

Academic Employment

2026– Assistant Professor at University of Barcelona.
Member of the BEAT Research Institute (Barcelona Economics Analysis Team), since October 2026.

2023–2026 Postdoctoral Fellow at University of Duisburg–Essen.
Project: Eugen Kovac's DFG funded *"Timing Games: Theory and Applications."*

2019–2022 Postdoctoral Fellow at CERGE–EI.
Project: Jakub Steiner's ERC funded *"Behavioral Implications of Information Processing."*

Education

2011–2019 Ph.D. in Economics, New York University.
Supervisor: Ennio Stacchetti. Thesis Title: *Revealing Private Information in a Patent Race*.

2010–2011 M.A. in Macroeconomic Policy and Financial Markets, Barcelona GSE.

2008–2010 M.Sc. in Financial Optimization, National Sun Yat-sen University
(Courses on Convex Analysis; Nonlinear Analysis; Financial Mathematics).

2005–2008 B.A. in Applied Mathematics, University of West Bohemia.

Honors, Scholarships, and Fellowships

2026 Two Rapid Grants, BlueDot Impact: for the frontier-lab profitability model (August) and for mentoring the SPAR project "The Economic Value of AI Capability Gains" (October).

2020, 2022 Teaching Fellowship, CERGE–EI Foundation.

2011–2016 MacCracken Scholarship, NYU.

2010–2011 La Caixa Scholarship, Barcelona GSE.

2008–2010 Taiwan Government Scholarship, NSYSU.

2005 Silver Medal, 46th IMO (International Mathematical Olympiad, details).

2003 Bronze Medal, 44th IMO.

Continuing Education

AI Safety Fellowships

2026 AI and Society Fellowship, Center for AI Safety (CAIS), San Francisco. Summer research fellowship (June–August); economic modeling of frontier-lab profitability as open-weight models catch up. Supported by a Rapid Grant from BlueDot Impact.

2026 Supervised Program for Alignment Research (SPAR), Race Dynamics Group, mentored by Katja Grace (AI Impacts). 3-month fellowship; formal modeling of competitive dynamics in AI development and incentives for safety investment. Certificate.

AI Safety Coursework

2026 Technical AI Safety Course (details), *BlueDot Impact*. 6–week program; certificate.

2025 AGI Strategy Course (details), *BlueDot Impact*. 5–week program; certificate.

2025 AI Safety, Ethics, and Society Course (AISES), *Center for AI Safety* (CAIS). 12–week program; certificate.

Other

2025 Summer School on Socioeconomic Opportunity and Inequality (details), Stone Center & YES. 24 hours; directors: Steven Durlauf, Ruben Enikolopov; certificate.

2020 Teaching Principles and Practices for Economics Course, Teaching Fellows. 30 hours; certificate.

Publications in Economics

Risk Perception: Measurement and Aggregation
with Nick Netzer, Arthur Robson, and Jakub Steiner
Journal of the European Economic Association 23(4), 1309–1349, 2025. [DOI] [paper]

Boundedly Rational Demand
with Jakub Steiner and Colin Stewart
Theoretical Economics 19(4), 1415–1442, 2024. [DOI] [paper]

Publications in Mathematics

Fixed point theorems and ergodic theorems for nonlinear mappings in Banach spaces
with Wataru Takahashi and Jen-Chih Yao
Advances in Mathematical Economics 14, 67–87, 2011. [DOI] [paper]

Weak and strong convergence theorems for generalized hybrid nonself-mappings in Hilbert spaces
with Wataru Takahashi and Jen-Chih Yao
Journal of Nonlinear and Convex Analysis 12(3), 453–470, 2011. [paper]

Fixed point theorems and weak convergence theorems for generalized hybrid mappings in Hilbert spaces
with Wataru Takahashi and Jen-Chih Yao
Taiwanese Journal of Mathematics 14(6), 2497–2511, 2010. [DOI] [paper]

An elementary new proof of the determination of a convex function by its subdifferential
Optimization 59(8), 1231–1233, 2010. [DOI] [paper]

Working Papers

Revealing Private Information in a Patent Race
with Eugen Kovac
[paper]

Work in Progress

Secrecy vs. Patenting in Innovation Races
with Eugen Kovac

The Economics of Frontier-AI Competition: Leader Profitability under Open-Weight Catch-Up
Preliminary draft, July 2026 — AI and Society Fellowship, Center for AI Safety. Supported by a Rapid Grant from BlueDot Impact. [model note] [interactive explorer]

Mentored Projects

SPAR — Fall 2026

The Economic Value of AI Capability Gains [project page]
Mentoring supported by a Rapid Grant from BlueDot Impact.

SAIGE — Spring 2026

Convergence or Divergence? The Future of Frontier AI Capabilities and Implications for Catastrophic Risk

Economic Decision-Making Under Deep Uncertainty About AI's Trajectory

Teaching Experience

2026 B.A. Introduction to Economics (taught in English, course page), University of Barcelona (UB).
M.A. Microeconomics I, Part I, Master in Economics (course page), UB.

2026 Facilitator, AI Safety Fundamentals (Atlas Curriculum), AI Safety Collab.
Led weekly discussion groups on AI capabilities, risks, strategies, and governance.

2025 M.A. Preparatory Microeconomics, American University of Armenia (AUA).
B.A. Intermediate Microeconomics, AUA.

2024 Ph.D. Preparatory Math, University of Duisburg–Essen.
M.A. Advanced Industrial Organization, University of Duisburg–Essen.

2022 Ph.D. Preparatory Mathematics, Center for Economic Research and Graduate Education – Economics Institute (CERGE–EI).
B.A. Applied Economics and Decision Under Uncertainty, School of Advanced Studies (SAS), University of Tyumen (UTMN).

2020 B.A. Microeconomics and Game Theory, SAS, UTMN.

2020–2021 Ph.D. Preparatory Microeconomics, CERGE–EI.

2015, 2017 Teaching Assistant for Ph.D. Math for Economists, Graduate School of Arts and Science (GSAS), New York University (NYU).

2013–2018 Teaching Assistant for B.A. courses in Microeconomics and Econometrics, GSAS, NYU and Stern School of Business, NYU.

Languages

English (fluent), Czech (native), Spanish (advanced).

Refereeing

Ad hoc referee: Review of Economic Studies; American Economic Review; Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization; Demonstratio Mathematica; Numerical Functional Analysis and Optimization.

Conference and Workshop Presentations

2025 Armenian Economic Association XV Annual Meetings; YES Summer School; 52nd Annual Conference of EARIE (Valencia).

2024 GAMES 2024 (Beijing); EEA 2024 (Rotterdam); Workshop on Timing Games (Bielefeld).

2023 Oligo Workshop 2023 (Padova); 13th Conference on Economic Design (Girona); 18th European Meeting on Game Theory (Messina).

2022 Young Economists' Meeting (Brno); Seminar presentation at University of Duisburg–Essen.

2020 EEA 2020 (Virtual); GAMES 2020 (Budapest).